

Sick and Tired of Being Sick and Tired

Human beings have always divided reality into light and darkness. We have seen the world through the language of fair and black, day and night, Deva and Rakshasa, order and force, engineer and source. The division itself is not a mistake. Reality contains forces that illuminate, distinguish, design, and organize, just as it contains forces that energize, dissolve, consume, and transform. The mistake begins when a functional difference is turned into a moral hierarchy, and one half of reality declares itself good while naming the other evil.

Darkness is no more evil than the night. It is no more evil than the soil in which a seed is buried, the current hidden inside a wire, the blood moving beneath the skin, or the unformed energy from which every act of creation must arise. Light allows us to see the machine. Darkness supplies the force that makes the machine move. An engineer may design a contraption of extraordinary beauty and precision, but without energy it remains an arrangement of lifeless material. Energy without form may scatter or destroy, but form without energy cannot act.

The engineer and the source are therefore incomplete without one another. Deva and Rakshasa, fair and dark, discipline and appetite, structure and force are not separate species of moral being. They are tendencies within reality and within every human being. No person is made entirely of light. No person is made entirely of darkness. Every individual contains the capacity to design and destroy, to restrain and consume, to illuminate and conceal, to serve and dominate.

The problem is not darkness. The problem is fear of darkness.

At some point, humanity began treating the unknown as an enemy rather than a necessary half of existence. What could not be seen clearly became dangerous. What appeared dark became associated with appetite, disorder, violence, and uncontrolled power. What appeared fair became associated with reason, cleanliness, hierarchy, and divine order. These symbolic divisions were eventually projected onto peoples and bodies, allowing difference in skin to become entangled with ancient fears concerning light and darkness.

But darkness was never the enemy. The enemy was the failure to synthesize.

A civilization that worships light alone becomes sterile. It produces structures, categories, machines, laws, and systems that are internally precise but disconnected from the energy of life. A civilization that worships force alone becomes unstable. It possesses vitality but cannot direct it without consuming itself. The purpose of civilization is not to choose one side. Its purpose is to conduct energy through form without allowing form to suffocate energy or energy to destroy form.

This is where ahamkaram and maryada become necessary.

Ahamkaram is the making of the "I." It is the boundary through which a human being becomes capable of saying: I am here; I act; I choose; I am responsible. Ahamkaram is not simply vanity. Without some coherent identity, no person could act intentionally or answer for the consequences of action. The self is a necessary instrument.

Yet the self can become too small or too large.

When the self becomes too small, it imprisons itself inside a narrow identity. It becomes permanently defensive. It interprets every difference as an insult and every boundary as an attack. It cannot meet another person without first asking whether that person confirms or threatens the identity it has built. Such a self may call itself master, slave, victim, ruler, white, black, righteous, oppressed, enlightened, or wounded. The label changes, but the prison remains.

When the self becomes too large, it loses the ability to recognize that anything exists independently of it. Other people become instruments, the earth becomes material, history becomes justification, and power becomes proof of moral worth. The enlarged self does not merely cross boundaries. It ceases to believe that any boundary possesses legitimacy unless the boundary serves its own expansion.

This is ahamkaram without maryada.

Maryada is the recognition that everything has a boundary, a place, a dignity, and a form that must not be approached carelessly. Maryada does not mean fear. It does not require paralysis, submission, or blind obedience to inherited rules. A boundary may be tested. It may be questioned. It may even need to be crossed. But it must be approached with attention because it may be carrying more than is immediately visible.

A riverbank restricts the river, yet it also gives the river direction. The insulation surrounding a wire limits the current, yet it allows that current to perform useful work. The walls of a vessel contain what would otherwise spill away. The boundaries within a person, a family, a society, an ecosystem, or a civilization may feel restrictive while actually preserving the conditions that make life possible.

To refuse ever to approach a boundary is fear. To cross it without understanding is ahamkaram. To approach it carefully, test it honestly, and accept responsibility for what follows is maryada.

There is no need for terror in any of this. Fear turns difference into hostility and uncertainty into violence. Maryada replaces fear with respect. It permits contact without consumption, resistance without hatred, and strength without domination. It does not tell us never to push. It tells us not to push blindly.

The same principle applies to suffering.

Human beings have spent thousands of years dividing themselves into masters and slaves, rulers and subjects, conquerors and conquered. We then mistake these positions for different species of human existence. We imagine that the slave suffers while the master is free. But a slave economy does not contain one enslaved class and one free class. It is an economy whose entire structure is enslaved and whose purpose is to produce further enslavement.

The person beneath the whip is enslaved through direct force. The person holding the whip is enslaved through property, fear, debt, status, law, reputation, dependence, and the identity that must be continuously defended. The master may live in a larger house, but the house is not freedom. He remains answerable to the creditor, the market, the court, the tax collector, the king, the crown, the rival, the family name, and the social order that grants him his position.

The king is not free. He serves the crown. The crown serves the court. The court serves its interests. Those interests serve fear, appetite, legitimacy, and collective ego. Each level appears free only because it can transfer its own bondage downward.

The entire system survives by teaching people to confuse relative power with freedom. The person holding the whip believes he has escaped suffering because he is not currently receiving the blow. But no human being escapes humanity. The master pays the same human tax, though it may arrive in another form: paranoia, humiliation, guilt, grief, fear of reversal, loss, spiritual disfigurement, dependence, or the destruction of everything he believed he possessed.

The whip is not the measure of suffering. Humanity is.

This does not erase action or responsibility. It makes responsibility universal. No one receives moral innocence from a label. No one is excused from fear, appetite, ego, cruelty, self-deception, or revenge simply because history placed them on one side of a conflict. Master and slave describe real positions, but they are not eternal spiritual identities. A slave can become a master. A master can become a slave. Both remain human, and therefore both remain answerable for what they do with pain and power.

There are no innocent peoples.

Every civilization has found ways to justify domination. Every wounded group has faced the temptation to convert suffering into permission. Every victorious group has told itself that its power proves its righteousness. Every defeated group has imagined that justice will arrive when it holds the weapon that was once used against it.

This is the failure that repeats through history.

Running from slavery may save a life. Killing the master may stop an immediate act of violence. Revolt may overturn a regime. All these actions may be necessary. But none of them alone solves the problem of slavery. They buy time. They change positions. They interrupt the machine without necessarily destroying its logic.

The deeper question begins after the running, the killing, and the overturning: what structure produced the master and the slave, and what discipline will prevent the victorious slave from rebuilding the same structure with new names?

Humanity has repeatedly defeated particular masters while preserving mastery itself. The former slave inherits the whip and believes justice has arrived because the correct person now holds it. Pain becomes inheritance. Injury becomes identity. Memory becomes permission. The next generation is taught whom it must blame, whom it must fear, and whom it may punish in the name of debts it did not create.

This is not liberation. It is role reversal.

The moral failure is not that a suffering person reacts in fear, rage, or desperation. Human beings break. They flee. They strike. They collapse. They cry. There is a time to grieve everything taken, wasted, or

destroyed. There is a time to mourn the years lost inside systems one did not create and could not immediately escape.

But suffering does not become sacred merely because it is real.

Pain can explain cruelty, but it cannot make cruelty right. Injury can explain revenge, but it cannot transform revenge into justice. No amount of historical suffering gives anyone the right to manufacture another sufferer. No person may use ancestry, victimhood, righteousness, weakness, strength, race, nation, caste, or religion to escape the obligations of decency.

Being wronged may justify the urgent act required to survive. It does not justify building the next world out of the same wrong.

This is the debt every human being owes to life. We may inherit fear, humiliation, violence, poverty, domination, or resentment. We may not have chosen what entered us. But we remain responsible for the form in which it leaves us.

There is a time to break down and cry for everything that was lost. But grief must not become a factory for new grief. The only answer worthy of suffering is transmutation: pain converted into beauty, art, wisdom, work, understanding, protection, and productivity. Every other choice risks vindicating the original conflict by accepting its claim that human beings can only transmit what they receive.

To pass the pain forward is to permit the conflict to survive through us.

The answer is not endless flight. It is not endless consumption. It is not the fantasy that one can escape slavery by enslaving someone else. The answer is to starve both the ego and the conflict that feeds upon it.

Sometimes this means fighting. Sometimes it means leaving. Sometimes it means refusing. Sometimes it means creating. Sometimes it means standing still while every instinct demands retaliation.

True hatred of slavery is not hatred of the slaveholder. Hatred directed at a person merely feeds the same structure by creating another identity that must be destroyed. True hatred of slavery is the willingness to sacrifice every pleasure slavery offers: revenge, superiority, innocence, domination, self-pity, and the relief of making another person carry one's pain.

To truly hate slavery is to become willing to do anything necessary to stop it from reproducing, including surrendering the satisfaction of retaliation.

There is a kind of courage required for this that is greater than conquest. It is the courage to absorb the arriving force without transmitting it in the same form. It is the discipline to say: this pain may enter me, but it will not leave me as cruelty. This humiliation may reach me, but it will not be handed to my children. This fear may pass through my body, but I will not build an institution around it.

That is *maryada*.

Maryada places a boundary around suffering. It says that pain may be acknowledged fully but may not be granted unlimited authority. It may speak, but it may not rule. It may be turned into art, beauty, productivity, memory, law, or protection, but it may not be converted into a licence to dominate.

The blackness of the soul created by slavery is not the same as darkness. Darkness is energy, mystery, possibility, and depth. The blackness created by slavery is untransformed pain: suffering converted into identity, appetite, resentment, and permission to make another person pay.

That blackness is not tied to skin. It appears wherever fear becomes structure and pain becomes inheritance. It lives in the master who must dominate to preserve himself and in the slave who dreams only of becoming master. It lives in the court, the crown, the plantation, the family, the workplace, the nation, and the individual ego whenever freedom is imagined as the power to bind someone else.

The line can stop.

It need not touch our children. But it will not stop through declarations of innocence. It will not stop because we identify ourselves with the correct side of history. It will not stop because we call our violence justice and another person's violence oppression.

It stops when someone stands before the inherited conflict and refuses every role it offers.

That person does not become passive. They may resist with extraordinary force. They may destroy the immediate instrument of domination. They may defend themselves, their family, and their community without apology. But they do not permit resistance to become a new identity organized around hatred. They do not confuse defeating the enemy with solving the problem.

The Gods, in this sense, are not beings who never suffer, fail, or become angry. They are those who refuse to transmit suffering unchanged. They possess an ahamkaram broad enough to contain both light and darkness without identifying entirely with either. They possess enough maryada to act with power while recognizing the boundary beyond which power becomes domination.

The task is not to abolish darkness. It is not to defeat whiteness, blackness, the master, the slave, or the self. The task is to stop turning partial identities into complete moral worlds.

White and dark are halves of one reality. Engineer and source are halves of one system. Deva and Rakshasa are tendencies moving through every person. Ahamkaram gives us the agency to act, but maryada determines whether our action produces life or repeats the machinery of destruction.

Light gives form.

Darkness gives force.

Ahamkaram gives agency.

Maryada gives proportion.

Only when these are held together can suffering be transformed rather than transmitted. Only then can the conflict reach a human being and discover that it can go no further.